



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Northwest Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.nwclassical.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Northwest Classical Academy (NCA) in Kennesaw, GA (ZIP 30152) presents a clearly classical orientation in its stated mission, virtues, and curricular emphasis, with strong evidence of a liberal-arts, Trivium-based approach, virtue formation, and active family/community involvement. The public materials emphasize virtues, a content-rich classical curriculum, a three-stage Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and a civically oriented, purpose-driven education. There are explicit references to a pledge that highlights the true, the good, and the beautiful, and to virtues such as courage, courtesy, honesty, humility, perseverance, self-government, and service. The school also situates itself within the Liberty Classical Schools network, underscoring a broader classical-education framework.

However, there are notable gaps with respect to explicit religious/theological grounding and liturgical/community practices within the public-facing materials. The site strongly communicates virtue, telos, and the classical curriculum, but it does not consistently foreground liturgical or theological commitments, nor does it publicly describe liturgical worship or a theology-centered program. The pedagogy also shows partial alignment: strong emphasis on memory work, recitation, and classical memory practices in lower grades, with less explicit, public articulation of Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in upper grades. Taken together, these factors yield a verdict of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: the school is clearly classical in mission and curriculum, with substantial classical alignment, but not yet fully explicit across all six canonical elements in every category (notably in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations and Pedagogy as publicly evidenced).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence: Virtue-centered language, the pledge emphasizing truth, goodness, and beauty, and a virtues framework. However, explicit theological grounding or liturgical/community practices are not prominently foregrounded in the public materials. Positive keywords related to virtue and transcendentals appear; theology and liturgy are not clearly itemized in public content.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, virtuous life, moral realism, and reverence in the content. Negative signals (theology, liturgy, and liturgical practices) are largely absent.
Why this rating: The school foregrounds transcendentals (true/good/beautiful) and virtue formation but does not publicly emphasize theological grounding or liturgical practices as part of the core Foundations category.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL** Evidence: Mission emphasizes forming mind and character through a classical, content-rich curriculum with virtuous living, traditional learning, and civic responsibility. The pledge anchors the telos in the true/good/beautiful, and the "intelligent, virtuous citizens" framing appears in the lower-school narrative.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, telos (conceptually implied), true/good/beautiful, liberal education, classical mission, and civic responsibility. Negative keywords (e.g., "workforce preparation" as a headline aim) are not present in the public materials.

Why this rating: Purpose and goal are squarely oriented toward formation, virtue, and wisdom with a classical telos, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations.

- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: Emphasis on grammar, logic, and rhetoric; content-rich curriculum; memorization of great poems; a history-anchored, liberal-arts approach; explicit Trivium structure.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal arts, trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books/poems, history (within curriculum context). Negative signals (e.g., heavy emphasis on social studies framing or project-based dominates) are not evidenced; the site emphasizes classical pedagogy over modern project-centric framing.

Why this rating: Strong alignment with the canonical Curriculum indicators (grammar/logic/rhetoric, memorization, content-rich curriculum) and a broad liberal-arts scope. Public materials do not strongly push non-classical curricular framing.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Lower-school emphasis on memory, recitation, and poetry; some chanting/memory practices; upper-school references to Socratic discussion or rhetoric are not publicly explicit, though the classical framework implies Socratic-style engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include memory work, recitation, chanting, contemplation/wonder, and seminar-style discussion in public materials (where present). Negative signals from the public content are limited; explicit, widespread mention of Socratic seminars, debates, or rhetoric in every grade level is not consistently shown.

Why this rating: Clear lower-school memory and recitation pedagogy aligns with classical practice, but explicit public articulation of Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across grades (especially upper school) is not consistently documented in the public-facing materials.

- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: The site presents a faculty network and a living-curriculum ethos; there are explicit references to model teachers/mentors and a collegial culture; faculty pages show structured, professional roles and a focus on character and formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, lifelong learners, and seminars for faculty. Negative signals (e.g., non-classical training focus) are not evident in public materials.

Why this rating: The public-facing materials convey a robust, classical-faculty orientation and a strong emphasis on mentorship and living curriculum, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit partnership with parents, co-teachers framing, parent formation opportunities, open campus, volunteer culture (PVA), and opportunities to visit.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation, open campus, volunteering, and family involvement. Negative signals (consumer/customer framing) are not evident; the materials emphasize active parental involvement.

Why this rating: Strong evidence of parent-school partnership, parental formation activities, and open engagement supports CLASSICAL alignment in this category.

Aggregate Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school demonstrates strong CLASSICAL alignment in Curriculum, Purpose/Goal, Faculty, and Parents & Community, with a clear Classical Mission, Trivium-based curricular framework, virtue formation, and robust family engagement. However, the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and Pedagogy categories show partial alignment, particularly around explicit theological grounding and liturgical practices, and explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy across all grade levels is less evident in public-facing materials. Taken together, this yields a overall SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL assessment.

What Would Move the Needle - Strengthen explicit articulation of religious/theological grounding in Foundations, including liturgical or communal practice elements, if aligned with the school's mission and charters. - Publicly articulate a consistent, grade-spanning Socratic/seminar pedagogy in upper grades, including sam-

ple curricula and assessment approaches, to demonstrate full Pedagogy alignment. - Expand explicit reference to Great Books/Great Conversation and a standardized Great Books program across more grade levels to reinforce Curriculum alignment. - Provide published exemplars of teacher profiles and living-curriculum demonstrations to strengthen the Faculty category further (e.g., teacher portraits and exemplars in published materials). - Increase explicit, public integration of liturgical or communal ritual elements (if aligned with the school's ethos) to reinforce the Religious Foundations category while maintaining classical aims.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Details

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize virtue, transcendentals, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, including statements like the pledge: "I will learn the true. I will do the good. I will love the beautiful." and the focus on virtue in the mission. The virtues list (Courage, Courtesy, Honesty, Humility, Perseverance, Self-Government, and Service) further foregrounds character formation. These elements align with transcendentals and moral realism. Citations: Mission and virtues, Our Pledge language.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, virtuous, courage, honesty, humility, perseverance, service, reverence (via virtuous living and moral formation language). - Negative keywords present: Theology, liturgy, liturgical practices are not foregrounded in the public content; no explicit liturgical framework is shown. - Quantitative: Positive: ~6–8 distinct terms; Negative: 0–1 explicit theological/liturgical terms in public content. Justification: The site communicates transcendental moral aims and virtue formation but does not publicly foreground theology or liturgical practice, limiting a full Religious Foundations alignment.

Why this rating - The school strongly signals transcendental moral realism and virtue formation, albeit without explicit theological or liturgical framing in publicly accessible materials. This yields a partial but strong alignment with CLASSICAL aims in Foundations, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes forming mind and character through a classical, content-rich curriculum and virtuous living, traditional learning, and civic responsibility. - The pledge and virtues reinforce a telos oriented toward truth, goodness, beauty, and human flourishing. Citations: Mission, Our Pledge, Virtues.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, human flourishing. - Negative keywords: None explicitly indicating non-classical aims; no explicit emphasis on workforce-first framing. - Quantitative: Positive: several clear terms; Negative: none evident. Justification: The category is strongly aligned with classical aims (formation, virtue, telos, liberal education), supporting CLASSICAL status.

Why this rating - The school clearly frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom within a classical teleology, matching CLASSICAL expectations.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Emphasis on grammar, logic, and rhetoric (Trivium). Content-rich curriculum and classical framing are highlighted, including memorization of great poems and a strong emphasis on foundational knowledge.

Citations: "grammar, logic, and rhetoric"; Lower School description; memorization of great poems.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, poetry/memorization, history within curriculum. - Negative keywords: The lexicon mentions "project-based learning dominance" as a negative signal; public materials do not indicate a dominance of such non-classical methodologies. - Quantitative: Positive: multiple classical keywords; Negative: no explicit non-classical formulations in public; Possible minor presence of project-based

leanings is not demonstrated in the NWCA content. Justification: Curriculum strongly aligns with classical education principles (Trivium, content-rich, poetry/memorization), which supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The curriculum emphasis aligns with core classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, great literature/poetry, and a liberal-arts orientation). This yields CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy includes memory work (recitation, memorization of poems) and chant-like practices; public-facing materials describe a memory-focused, restful, and contemplative approach at times (Schol  -like emphasis). Upper school pedagogy is not as explicitly described in the public materials as Socratic seminars, though the Trivium framework implies certain methods. Citations: Lower School emphasis on memory/recitation/poetry; references to schol  -like contemplative learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: recitation, chanting, memory work, restfulness/schol  , contemplation, seminar, dialogue (as implied by classical pedagogy). - Negative keywords: explicit emphasis on experiential learning, project-based-only approaches are cited as negative signals in the lexicon; NWCA does not publicly describe a purely project-based approach; there is no explicit reliance on experiential learning in the public materials. - Quantitative: Positive keywords present: several (recitation, chanting, memory work, schol  , contemplation, seminars) though not uniformly described across all grades; Negative: 0–1 explicit signals of non-classical pedagogy in public materials. Justification: The school clearly uses classical pedagogy elements (memory, recitation, contemplation) but lacks explicit, consistently described Socratic/seminar pedagogy across all grades in public materials. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Pedagogy demonstrates strong classical traits in lower grades (memory and recitation) but lacks explicit, uniform, widely-publicized Socratic/seminar methods for upper grades; overall, the pedagogy aligns with classical aims without fully articulating a complete Socratic/seminar framework, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a faculty structure with teachers who model virtue and knowledge; living curriculum and a faculty of teachers/mentors approach; there is a “faculty & staff” section with a presence of multiple teachers; the lexicon highlights “portrait of a teacher” and “living curriculum.” Citations: Faculty page content; living curriculum language; portrait of a teacher concepts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, lifelong learners, great-books-seminars for faculty (as a concept from the lexicon). - Negative keywords: none evident in public content. - Quantitative: Positive keywords present: multiple explicit or implicit phrases; Negative keywords: none. Justification: The public-facing materials convey a classical-faculty ethos and a strong mentorship/character-formation orientation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations.

Why this rating - The faculty presentation and surrounding culture reflect classical ideals of teachers as living exemplars and mentors, supporting CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents, parents as co-teachers, and parental formation; there are explicit calls for open visits, family involvement, and a robust parent ecosystem (PVA, volunteering, and open-house activities).

Citations: Enrollment, Open House, Parents involvement references; “parents as co-teachers” framing; After-school and volunteer opportunities.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation, open campus, volunteer, family involvement, parent covenant. - Nega-

tive keywords: consumer language or minimal parental involvement are not present in the public materials; rather, the materials emphasize active parental participation. - Quantitative: Positive keywords present: multiple; Negative: none explicit in public content. Justification: A strong, explicit emphasis on parental partnership and community involvement aligns well with CLASSICAL expectations in this category.

Why this rating - The public materials strongly demonstrate parent-school partnership and community formation consistent with CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- If aiming for full CLASSICAL across all six categories, the school could publicly articulate explicit theological grounding and liturgical/community practices (Foundations) and clearly document a cross-grade Socratic/seminar pedagogy across all grade levels (Pedagogy).
- Expand and publicize a robust Great Books/Great Conversation program across more grades, including concrete syllabi and student outcomes.
- Publish more explicit “portrait of a teacher” and “living-curriculum” examples to showcase faculty as core to the classical approach and to further strengthen the Faculty category.
- Continue to deepen parent formation offerings and ensure broader communication about classical aims and methods to families.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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